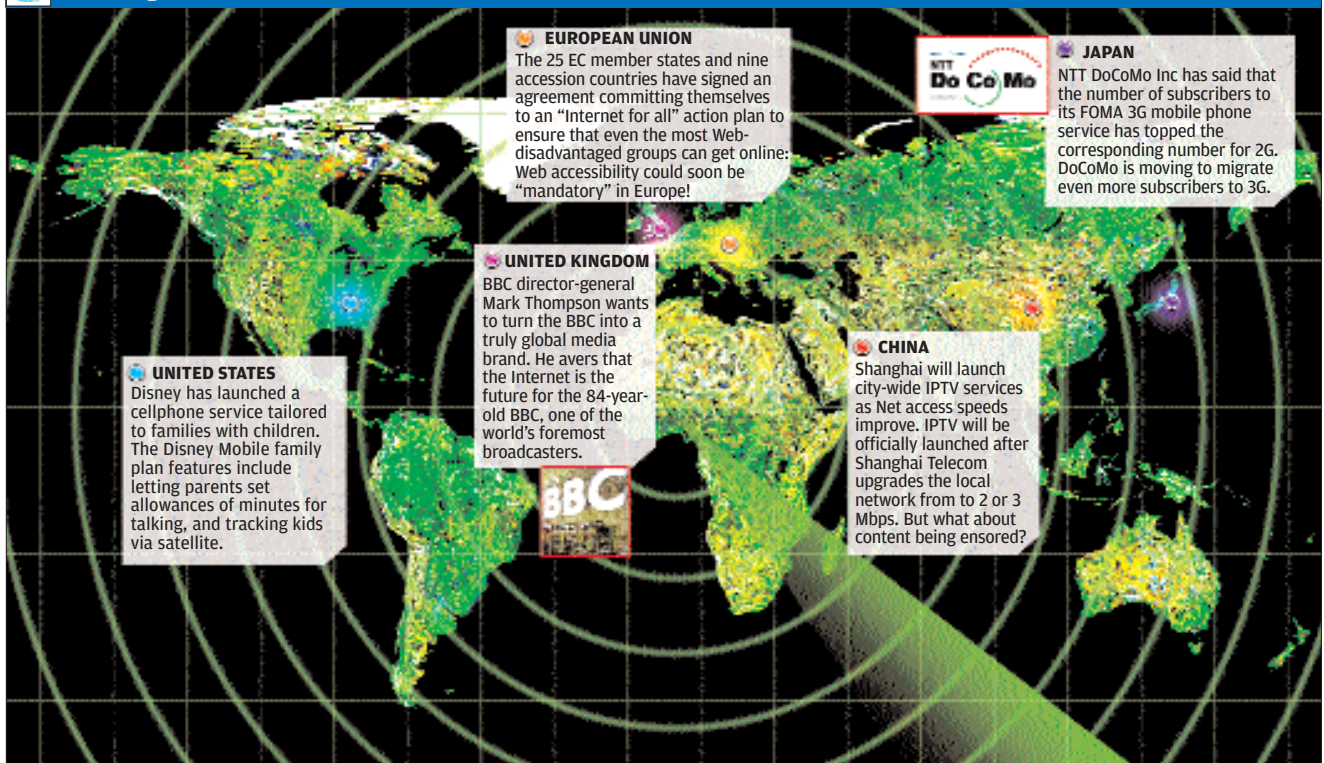




that is centrally managed to transfer calls to a traditional phone network.

The case is interesting because it seems so frivolous. The patent in question is the "point-to-point IP" patent, which details the "exchange of IP addresses between processing units in order to establish a direct communications link between the devices via the Internet."

First thoughts: the above seems so ambiguous, it describes almost every data transaction on the Internet! How could Net2Phone have been granted this patent? They could sue anyone on this basis! The Internet is all about two IPs communicating with each other, and at first sight, Net2Phone seems to have copyrighted the Internet!

Now, when one reads the patent abstract, it doesn't seem as general as all that, but it still seems to describe all P2P and IM systems. We haven't read the entire patent, but in all probability (American lawyers certainly aren't

stupid), the patent is probably much more complex.

The question, however, raises its head: why wait so long? Why not sue when Skype started off? This is almost identical to the situation we reported last month in this space, with Creative suing Apple for a patent on a *user interface*. Net2Phone seems to have waited for Skype to be acquired by a large company before making their move.

Perhaps we'll see a new law that bans suing so late in the day! But the question we're asking now is, will Skype sue back? Will Skype win? Or will the case be dismissed on grounds of frivolity?

IN THE UK AND SOUTH KOREA

Mobile TV Trials

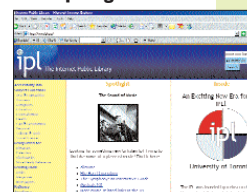
Is the time ripe for Imobile TV, and will DAB work? That's what providers in the UK and South Korea are going to



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

A Library, Straight Dope and

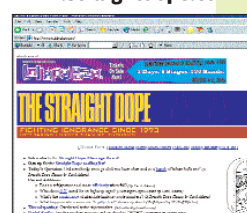
www.ipl.org



The Internet Public Library

Visit this site to get an idea of how much information you can access! The pane at the left is infinitely expandable—hover your mouse over a heading and you get 10 categories, with sub-headings. With categories such as Almanacs, Dictionaries, Science & Tech, the site links to hundreds of sites, and is comparable to the old directory-style Yahoo!.

www.straightdope.com



The Straight Dope

"Fighting ignorance since 1973." The Straight Dope answers such questions as "How do you donate your body to science?" and "How do they get beer into cans?" OK, these might seem silly, but imagine that you can get answers to almost any weird question, and you have the ultimate trivia site at your fingertips. What does "OK" stand for? What is a mojo? Go ahead, it's all searchable!

www.lifehacker.com



Lifehacker

The site calls itself the "Productivity and Software Guide." A humongous homepage boasts of an eclectic collection of, well, links and articles. Back up your mac the smart way. Download of the Day: Gmail Remote Command. The Daily news roundup. Save your aching wrists; switch your mousing hand. Eclectic, like we said. You need to take a look. We loved it.